

Word family: **commute / commutes / commuted / commuting / commuter / commutation / telecommute / telecommuting**

Base word: commute

Verb forms: commute, commutes, commuted, commuting

Noun: commute

Related forms: commuter, commutation

Useful modern extensions: telecommute, telecommuting, commuter train, commuter route, commuter town

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “At that time, I was **commuting** every day...”

A full family sweep shows that **commute** has a very important everyday meaning, but it also has several genuinely distinct legal, financial, and mathematical meanings.

The major modern senses are:

1. regularly travel between home and work/school;
2. noun: that regular journey;
3. law: reduce/change a punishment;
4. finance: convert a series of payments into another form, often a lump sum;
5. mathematics: two operations can be performed in either order with the same result.

Meaning in your passage

Here, **commuting** means:

regularly travelling between home and your workplace, usually following the same route each working day.

繁體中文： ** **定期往返住所與工作地點之間通勤，通常是每天上班和下班的固定旅程

Natural translation:

> “At that time, I was commuting every day.”

「那段時間，我**每天都要通勤上下班**。」

So:

commute = 定期往返住所與工作 / 上學地點

1. **commute between home and + workplace/school (住所與工作 / 學校) — 通勤；往返上下班 / 上學**

This is your original meaning.

****Meaning:**** To travel regularly between your home and the place where you work or study.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I was **commuting** every day.”

「我當時**每天都要通勤**。」

Practice 2

> “She **commutes** from the suburbs to the city centre.”

「她每天從郊區**通勤到市中心上班**。」

Practice 3

> “Thousands of people **commute** into the city each morning.”

「每天早上有數以千計的人**通勤進城上班**。」

****commute = 按固定或經常性的模式往返住所與工作 / 上學地點****

2. **commute by + transport (交通工具) — 乘……通勤**

Practice 4

> “I **commute by train**.”

「我**乘火車通勤**。」

Practice 5

> “Many employees **commute by bus**.”

「很多員工**乘巴士上下班**。」

****commute by + transport = 使用某種交通工具定期往返工作 / 上學地點****

Common patterns:

- * commute by train
- * commute by bus
- * commute by car
- * commute by bicycle

3. ****commute from A to B (起點 / 終點) — 從 A 通勤到 B****

Practice 6

> “He ****commutes from Seattle to Bellevue****.”

「他每天****從西雅圖通勤到貝爾維尤****。」

Practice 7

> “She commutes ****from home to university****.”

「她每天****從家中通勤到大學****。」

****commute from A to B = 定期從居住地 A 往返工作 / 學習地點 B****

4. ****a commute = regular journey to/from work or school — 通勤路程；上下班車程****

Here, ****commute**** is a noun.

Practice 8

> “My morning ****commute**** takes about forty minutes.”

「我早上的****通勤車程****大約四十分鐘。」

Practice 9

> “He has a long ****commute****.”

「他的****上下班通勤路程很長****。」

****a commute = 從家到工作 / 學校及相關往返的固定旅程****

5. **long/short/easy/difficult commute** — 長 / 短 / 輕鬆 / 辛苦的通勤路程

Practice 10

> “A two-hour **commute** can be exhausting.”

「兩小時的**通勤路程**可以令人筋疲力盡。」

Practice 11

> “Moving closer to the office gave her a much shorter **commute**.”

「搬到公司附近後，她的**通勤時間**大幅縮短。」

This is the same noun sense, but an extremely common context.

6. **commuter** = person who regularly travels to work/school — 通勤者；通勤上班 / 上學的人

Practice 12

> “The train was packed with morning **commuters**.”

「火車擠滿了早上的**通勤乘客**。」

Practice 13

> “The new service is aimed at **commuters**.”

「這項新服務主要是為**通勤人士**而設。」

commuter = 定期往返住所與工作 / 學校地點的人

This is directly relevant to your passage.

7. **commuter + train/service/route** (交通) — 通勤用的；服務通勤者的

Practice 14

> “The city introduced more **commuter trains**.”

「城市增加了更多**通勤列車**。」

Practice 15

> “This is one of the busiest **commuter routes**.”

「這是其中一條最繁忙的**通勤路線**。」

commuter + noun = 主要為定期上下班 / 上學乘客提供服務的

Common:

* commuter train = 通勤列車

* commuter rail = 通勤鐵路

* commuter bus = 通勤巴士

* commuter route = 通勤路線

8. **commuter town / commuter suburb — 通勤城鎮；通勤市郊住宅區**

A useful geographical/social extension.

Practice 16

> “The town has become a popular **commuter town**.”

「這個城鎮已成為很受歡迎的**通勤城鎮**。」

Practice 17

> “Many residents of the **commuter suburb** work in the city.”

「這個**通勤市郊住宅區**的很多居民都在市中心工作。」

commuter town/suburb = 很多居民住在當地，但每天前往另一城市 / 地區工作的小鎮或住宅區

9. **commute + sentence/punishment (法律) — 減刑；把刑罰改為較輕刑罰**

This is a genuinely different meaning.

Meaning: To officially reduce a legal punishment or change it to a less severe one.

Practice 18

> “The governor **commuted** the sentence.”

「州長把刑罰**減輕 / 減刑**。」

Practice 19

> “His death sentence was **commuted to** life imprisonment.”

「他的死刑被**減為終身監禁**。」

commute a sentence = 由有權機關把原本刑罰改成較輕的刑罰

Very important pattern:

> **commute A to B**

= **把 A 刑罰減 / 改為 B**

10. **commutation** = reduction/substitution of a legal sentence — 減刑；刑罰變更

The noun counterpart.

Practice 20

> “The prisoner applied for a **commutation** of his sentence.”

「囚犯申請**減刑 / 改判較輕刑罰**。」

Practice 21

> “The president granted a **commutation**.”

「總統批准了**減刑**。」

commutation — law = 正式把原有刑罰減輕或改成另一種較輕刑罰

Important distinction: commutation vs pardon

This is extremely important in legal English.

commutation

= punishment is reduced or changed.

The conviction normally remains.

pardon

= official forgiveness for the offence, with different legal effects depending on the system.

So:

> **commute a 20-year sentence to 10 years**

= 把 20 年刑期減至 10 年

That is **not the same as pardoning the person**.

11. **commute + pension/payments (金融) — 把定期付款轉換為一次性付款 / 另一付款形式**

A genuine financial meaning.

****Meaning:**** To exchange a future series of payments or benefits for a different form, often a lump sum.

Practice 22

> “She chose to **commute** part of her pension into a lump sum.”

「她選擇把部分退休金**轉換成一次性整筆付款**。」

Practice 23

> “The plan allows members to **commute** some future benefits.”

「這項計劃容許成員把部分未來福利**轉換成另一種付款形式**。」

****commute — finance = 把一連串定期或未來付款折算 / 轉換成另一種付款形式，常見為一次性款項****

This is much more formal than the everyday travel meaning.

12. ****commutation = conversion of recurring payments/benefits — 折算；一次性轉換****

Practice 24

> “The pension scheme permits partial ****commutation****.”

「這個退休金計劃容許部分福利作****一次性折算 / 轉換****。」

Practice 25

> “The amount payable after ****commutation**** depends on the scheme rules.”

「完成****折算轉換****後可取得的款項取決於計劃規則。」

****commutation — finance = 把定期付款或權益折算成一次性或另一種付款形式的過程****

13. ****A and B commute (數學) — 可交換次序而結果不變；可交換****

This is a genuinely distinct academic meaning.

****Meaning:**** Two mathematical operations or objects ****commute**** if changing their order does not change the result.

Practice 26

> “Addition and multiplication of ordinary numbers are individually commutative, but subtraction does not ****commute**** in the same way.”

「普通數字的加法和乘法各自具有交換性，但減法則不能以相同方式****交換次序而保持結果不變****。」

Practice 27

> “These two operators ****commute****.”

「這兩個算符****可以交換次序而不改變結果****。」

****commute — mathematics = 兩個運算 / 算符改變先後次序後，所得結果仍相同****

For example:

> $A \times B = B \times A$

in an appropriate mathematical context.

14. **commutative** = order can be reversed without changing result (數學) — 可交換的；具有交換律的

This is an important related mathematical form.

Practice 28

> “Addition is **commutative**.”

「加法具有**交換律**。」

Practice 29

> “Matrix multiplication is not generally **commutative**.”

「矩陣乘法一般**不具交換性**。」

commutative = 改變運算對象的先後次序而結果仍然相同的

This is a technical family extension, but useful for maths learners.

15. **telecommute** = work remotely instead of travelling to the workplace — 遙距工作；在家工作而免通勤

A very useful modern family extension.

Practice 30

> “She **telecommutes** three days a week.”

「她每星期有三天**遙距工作**、不用到公司通勤。」

Practice 31

> “Many employees began to **telecommute**.”

「很多員工開始**在家 / 遙距工作**。」

telecommute = 利用電話、電腦和網絡在遠端工作，而不需要親身通勤到一般工作地點

Nowadays, **work remotely / work from home** is often more common in everyday English, but

****telecommute**** remains useful.

16. ****telecommuting = remote working replacing physical commuting — 遙距工作；遠端辦公****

Practice 32

> “Telecommuting can reduce travel time.”

「****遙距工作****可以減少通勤時間。」

Practice 33

> “The company introduced a ****telecommuting**** policy.”

「公司引入了****遙距工作政策****。」

****telecommuting = 透過資訊科技在遠端完成工作，以代替每天前往固定辦公地點****

17. ****reverse commute = travel opposite to the main rush-hour flow — 逆向通勤****

A useful transport extension.

Practice 34

> “He has a ****reverse commute**** from the city to the suburbs.”

「他每天從市中心前往郊區上班，屬於****逆向通勤****。」

Practice 35

> “A reverse commute can sometimes mean less traffic.”

「****逆向通勤****有時意味著交通較暢順。」

****reverse commute = 通勤方向與大多數上班族的繁忙時段主要流向相反****

For example:

> most people: suburb → city

> reverse commuter: city → suburb

Important distinction: **commute** vs **travel**

You already curated **travel**, and this distinction is essential.

travel

very broad:

= go from one place to another.

commute

much narrower:

= regularly travel between home and work/school.

> “I travel to Japan twice a year.”

「我每年去日本兩次。」

Not normally a **commute**.

> “I commute to work by train every day.”

「我每天乘火車通勤上班。」

So:

all commuting is travel, but not all travel is commuting.

Important distinction: **commute** vs **journey**

commute

emphasizes the **regular routine**.

journey

means one individual trip from one place to another.

> “My commute is usually easy.”

「我的日常通勤通常很順利。」

> “Today’s journey took two hours.”

「今天這趟旅程用了兩小時。」

Your commute consists of repeated journeys.

Important distinction: **commute** vs **trip**

commute

regular journey between home and work/school.

trip

a particular visit/journey, often temporary and not routine.

> “a daily commute”

= 每日通勤

> “a business trip”

= 出差

A business trip is usually **not** a commute.

Important distinction: **commute** vs **drive**

commute

describes the purpose/routine of the journey.

drive

describes the transport/action of controlling a car.

You can:

* commute by train

* commute by bus

* commute by bicycle

* commute on foot in some contexts

So **commute** does not mean **drive**.

Important distinction: **commuter vs **passenger****

**passenger**

any person travelling in a vehicle without driving it.

**commuter**

someone making a regular home-to-work/school journey.

A tourist on a train is a:

> passenger

but not normally a:

> commuter.

A commuter on a train is **both**.

Important distinction: **commute vs **telecommute****

**commute**

physically travel between home and workplace.

**telecommute**

perform the work remotely instead, using communication technology.

So rather amusingly:

> **telecommuting usually means not commuting physically.**

Important legal distinction: **commute vs **overtake****

**commute a sentence**

= keep the conviction/punishment structure but reduce the punishment.

overturn a conviction

= reverse the legal judgment itself.

These are legally very different.

Important grammar: **commute to / from / between**

Destination

> commute **to** work

Origin

> commute **from** the suburbs

Two endpoints

> commute **between** Seattle and Bellevue

Transport

> commute **by** train

These can combine:

> “She commutes **from Tacoma to Seattle by train**.”

「她每天從塔科馬乘火車通勤到西雅圖。」

Important countability note

Verb

> “I commute every day.”

Countable noun

> “I have a long commute.”

So unlike **travel**, which is normally uncountable as an activity:

> “Travel is tiring.”

commute very naturally forms a countable noun:

> “a 45-minute commute”

= 45 分鐘通勤車程

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

- * **commute — travel** = 定期上下班 / 上學通勤
- * **a commute** = 通勤路程 / 通勤時間
- * **commuter** = 通勤者
- * **commuter train/rail/bus** = 通勤列車 / 鐵路 / 巴士
- * **commuter town/suburb** = 通勤城鎮 / 通勤市郊
- * **commute a sentence** = 減刑
- * **commutation — law** = 減刑 / 刑罰變更
- * **commute payments/pension** = 折算 / 轉換定期款項
- * **commutation — finance** = 定期權益的折算轉換
- * **commute — mathematics** = 交換運算次序而結果不變
- * **commutative** = 具有交換性的 / 符合交換律的
- * **telecommute** = 遙距工作
- * **telecommuting** = 遙距工作制度 / 活動
- * **reverse commute** = 逆向通勤

There is also **commutator** in electrical engineering and mathematics, but that moves into a more specialized technical family. Under our rule of useful modern exhaustiveness rather than dictionary-total exhaustiveness, I would leave it out unless we are specifically teaching engineering or higher mathematics.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
commute — work/school	定期往返住所與固定工作 / 學習地點
commute by + transport	使用某種交通工具定期上下班 / 上學
a commute	從住所到工作 / 學校及相關往返的固定通勤旅程
commuter	定期往返住所與工作 / 學習地點的人

commuter train/route	主要為日常上下班 / 上學通勤者提供服務的交通工具 / 路線	
commuter town/suburb	很多居民住在當地但前往另一地區工作的小鎮 / 住宅區	
commute a sentence	由有權機關把原有刑罰改成較輕的刑罰	
commutation — law	正式減輕或變更某人的刑罰	
commute — finance	把未來定期付款 / 福利轉換為一次性或另一付款形式	
commutation — finance	定期付款 / 福利的折算或轉換過程	
commute — mathematics	兩個運算或算符交換先後次序後結果仍相同	
commutative	改變運算順序而結果不變、具有交換律的	
telecommute	利用資訊科技在遠端工作，以代替親身前往一般工作地點	
reverse commute	通勤方向與主要繁忙時段人流方向相反	

For your original sentence

> “At that time, I was ****commuting every day****...”

The exact meaning is:

****commuting = 每天在住所和工作地點之間定期往返****

And because the next clause mentions:

> “the train was so noisy and crowded”

the passage strongly suggests:

> ****commuting by train****

So naturally:

> “I was commuting every day.”

= ****「那段時間，我每天都要通勤上下班。」****